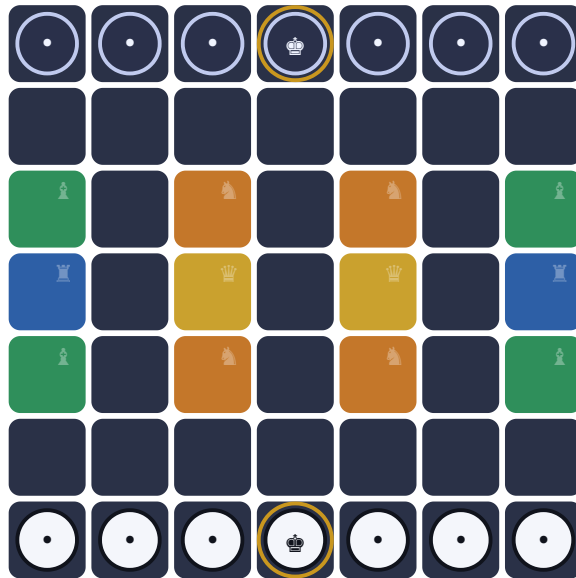


FACET

A chess-inspired strategy game for 2 players

Ages 10+ · 15–30 minutes · square board



Player's Guide · Classic 7x7 board shown · 10 boards, 3 optional modes

Objective

Every stone is identical — what it can do is granted entirely by the **terrain tile** it stands on. Move your stones across the board, using the tiles beneath them, until you either capture the enemy **Monarch**, hold both **Thrones** long enough to be crowned, or strip the enemy down to a bare Monarch with nothing left to fight with.

The Board

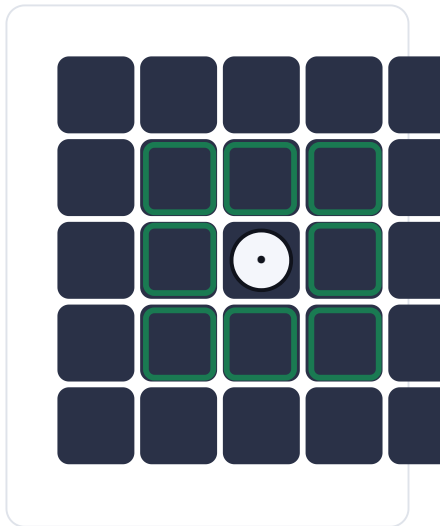
A square grid (7×7, 8×8, or 9×9 depending on the board). Every board is 180° rotationally symmetric with exactly two Throne tiles, so neither side starts with a geometric advantage. Five terrain types are scattered across it:

Tile	Name	Grants this move
 Field	Step 1 square in any direction (like a king).	
 Tower	Slide horizontally or vertically, any distance (like a rook).	
 Spire	Slide diagonally, any distance (like a bishop).	
 Gate	Leap in an L-shape, ignoring anything in between (like a knight).	
 Throne	Slide in all 8 directions, any distance (like a queen) — also a win objective.	

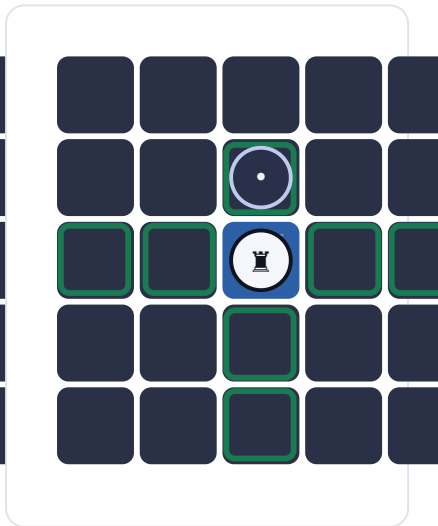
A stone's move is **not fixed** — it's whatever the tile underneath currently grants. Slide a piece from a Tower onto a Gate and its next move is a knight-leap, not a rook-slide. The board itself is the most important piece.

Terrain & Movement

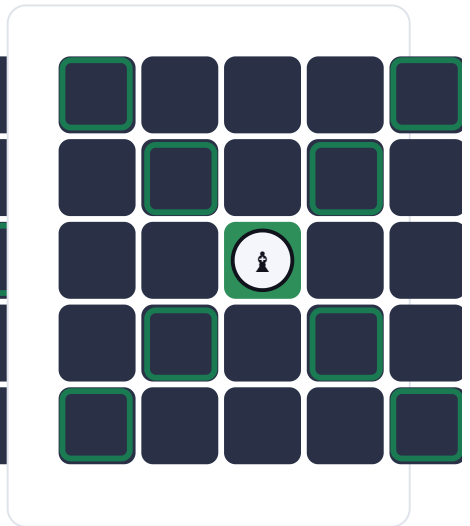
Sliders (Tower, Spire, Throne) travel any distance in their directions until blocked by a piece — landing on an enemy captures it, landing on your own is illegal, and you stop right there either way. The Gate leaps in an L exactly like a knight and never cares what's in between.



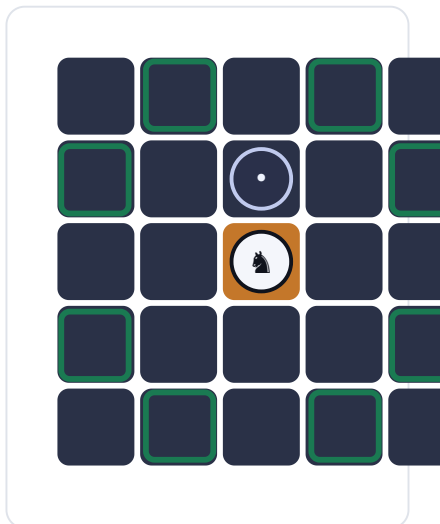
Field: 1 step, any of the 8 directions.



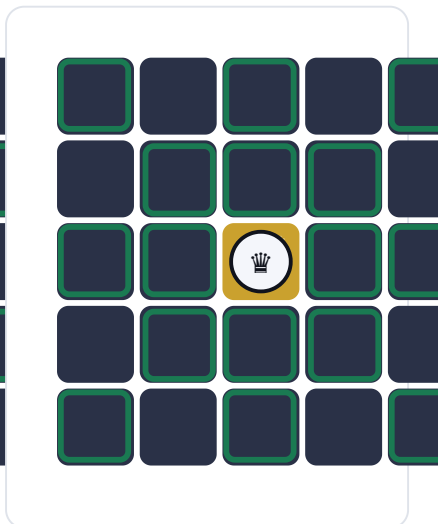
Tower: slides orthogonally — an enemy in the way is captured, and the slide stops there.



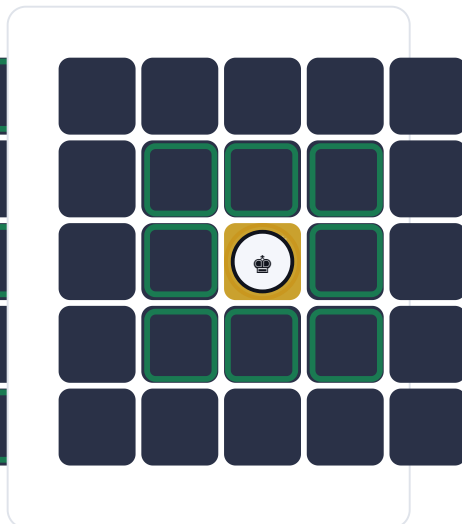
Spire: slides diagonally, same blocking rule.



Gate: leaps in an L — the piece one square away is completely irrelevant, the leap ignores it.



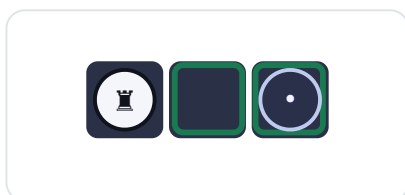
Throne: slides in all 8 directions — a Tower and a Spire's movement combined.



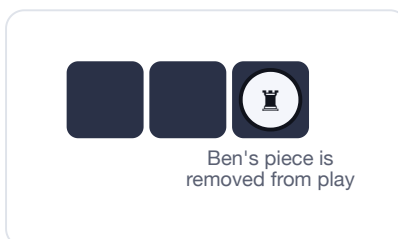
The Monarch is the one exception: always exactly 1 step, no matter which tile it stands on — even a Throne.

Capture

Land on a square occupied by an enemy stone to capture it — it's removed from the game immediately. You may never land on your own stone. Sliders stop the instant they capture; they can't continue past it in the same move.



Ana's Tower can slide onto either empty square, or capture Ben's stone two squares away.



Landing on it removes it from play — Ana's piece now stands on that square.

Winning the Game

Three ways to win — no draw-by-points here, every decisive game ends in exactly one of these:



captured — game over immediately (Regicide)

Regicide — capture the enemy Monarch. Game over immediately, no matter the material on the board.



held 3 of 3 rounds
→ Coronation win

Coronation — hold every Throne tile for a full round (3 plies). The opponent always gets one turn to contest it first before it counts.



no agents left —
bare Monarch loses on the spot

Elimination — the enemy is reduced to a bare Monarch with no other stones left. Even undefeated, a lone Monarch immediately loses.

If the player to move has no legal move at all, the game is a **draw**. Either side may also offer a draw at any time; the opponent can accept or decline.

Optional Modes

Selected before the game starts; the board list only offers layouts that were simulation-tested for whichever mode is active.

Terrain Decay

Every time a stone *leaves* a special tile, that tile degrades one tier — permanently, for both players. Thrones never decay. Movement power becomes a resource you spend, not a fixture of the map.



Tower

A Tower, about to be vacated.

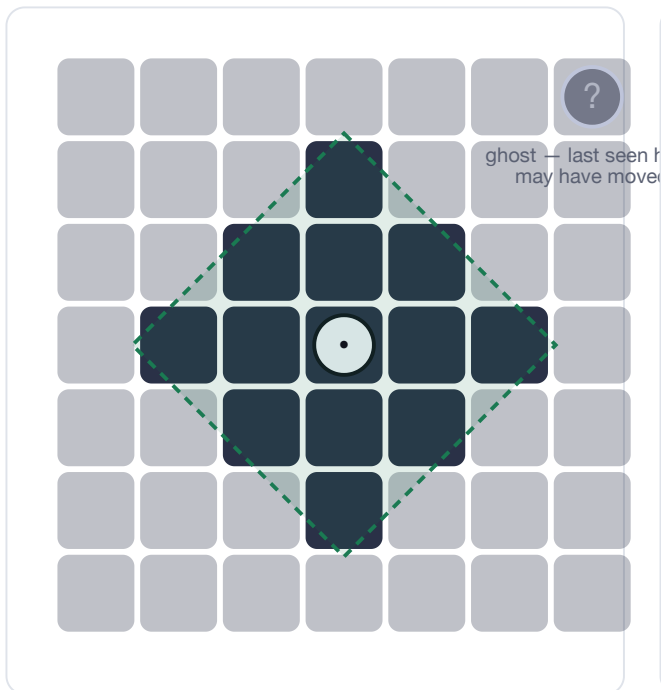


degraded to Spire
(the tile the stone left)

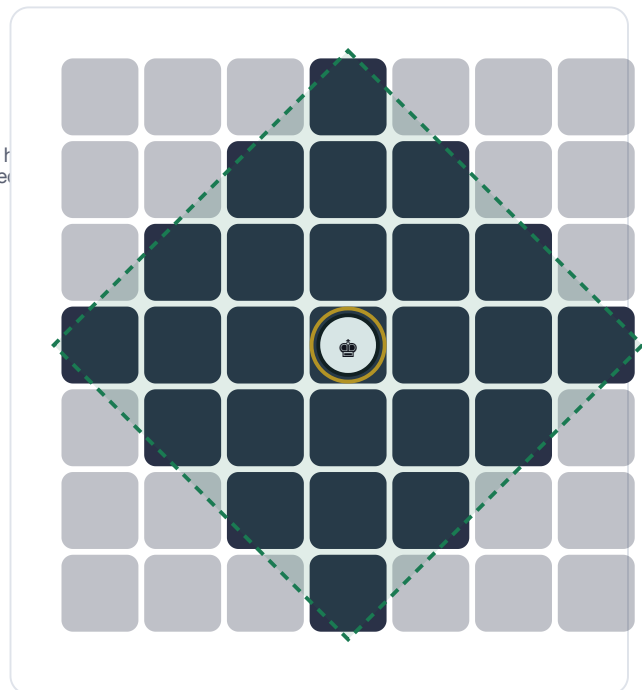
Tower → Spire → Gate → Field — one tier per departure. The next stone to land here inherits whatever tier is left.

Fog of War

Each side sees only a radius around their own stones — Manhattan distance 2 for ordinary stones, 3 around the Monarch. Thrones are always visible to both sides regardless of distance. Enemy stones you've spotted linger as faded **ghosts** at their last-known square after they leave your sight — useful memory, but they may not still be there.

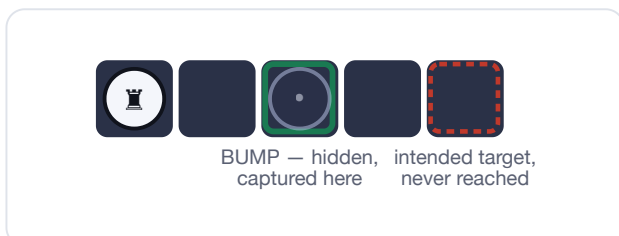


An ordinary stone's sight (radius 2). The enemy stone outside it is remembered as a ghost, not seen live.



The Monarch sees further — radius 3 — reflecting the extra danger it's in.

Because a slider's path can cross a square you can't currently see, moves are planned on your own fog view — if that path actually crosses a hidden enemy, the slide **bumps**: it stops at the first hidden piece it meets and captures it there, instead of reaching wherever you intended.



You slide intending $(0,0) \rightarrow (4,0)$. An enemy you couldn't see was waiting at $(2,0)$ — the slide stops and captures it there instead.

The AI plays fog games under the exact same blindfold — it never peeks at the full board, and keeps the same kind of short-term memory of recent sightings a human player would.

Momentum

A stone that leaves a special tile keeps that tile's rank for **one more move**, layered on top of whatever its new tile grants. The retained rank is public information (shown as a badge on the stone) and expires the move after next. Leaving a Throne this way keeps the queen-slide alive for one extra move — throne raids get a real exit, instead of being stranded the instant they retreat.



Throne

A Queen-mover on the Throne...



on a Field tile now, but still queen-slides for 1 more move

...slides off to a Field tile. It only steps 1 square from here on its OWN tile grant, but the retained badge means this next move can still be a full queen-slide.

Momentum is mutually exclusive with Decay and Fog — pick at most one mode per game.

Side Choice & Difficulty

White moves first — a measurable advantage — so before each game you choose to play White, Black, or Random; your own stones always render at the bottom of the screen regardless. Against the AI, pick Easy, Normal, or Hard: deeper difficulties search further ahead and take longer to move, including proposing and evaluating their own draw offers based on the position.

Strategy Tips

- Watch the tile, not the piece — the same stone is a lumbering Field-walker one move and a rook on the next, purely because of where it's standing.
- The Gate ignores everything in its path. In cramped, piece-dense positions it's often your only stone that can actually reach a square this turn.
- Never let your Monarch's safety depend on "the enemy probably won't find a way in" — Regicide ends the game outright, no matter how far ahead you are on material.
- Coronation gives the opponent exactly one turn to contest a Throne you're about to lock down — that turn is your last chance to break the hold, not a moment to waste elsewhere.
- Running an enemy down to their last non-Monarch piece is just as final as capturing their King — count remaining agents, not just position.
- In Fog games, a ghost marker is memory, not certainty — don't slide a valuable piece through a square you merely *remember* being empty.

Quick Reference

Tile	Grants	Tile	Grants
 Field	step 1	 Gate	knight leap
 Tower	rook slide	 Throne	queen slide
 Spire	bishop slide		

Rule	Value
Win conditions	Regicide, Coronation (hold all Thrones 3 plies), Elimination (bare Monarch)
Monarch move	always 1 step, ignores terrain
No legal move	draw (or by mutual agreement any time)
Decay chain	Tower → Spire → Gate → Field (Thrones never decay)
Fog sight radius	2 (ordinary), 3 (Monarch); Thrones always visible
Momentum	retained rank lasts 1 extra move; not combinable with Decay/Fog